

Bandit Level 2 → Level 3

Objective

Find the password for **Bandit Level 3** from a file with a special filename.

Execution

1. Log in as **bandit2**

After connecting to Level 2, check the files in the current directory:

```
ls -al
```

You should find a file named:

--spaces in this filename--

Purpose:

`ls -al` shows the files present in the directory, including hidden files.

```
bandit2@bandit:~$ ls -al
total 24
-rw-r----- 1 bandit3 bandit2  33 Jun 24 14:59 --spaces in this filename--
drwxr-xr-x  2 root    root    4096 Jun 24 14:59 .
drwxr-xr-x 150 root    root    4096 Jun 24 15:02 ..
-rw-r--r--  1 root    root     220 Feb 13  2026 .bash_logout
-rw-r--r--  1 root    root    3851 Jun 24 14:50 .bashrc
-rw-r--r--  1 root    root     807 Feb 13  2026 .profile
```

2. Read the file

Because the filename starts with `--` and contains spaces, use the path `./` and quotation marks:

```
cat "./--spaces in this filename--"
```

Purpose:

`./` specifies the current directory, while quotes make sure the spaces in the filename are treated as part of the filename.

The command will display the password for the next level:

7ZZZ2LFrykP2zEyvBL4m3clL7tGYJPME

Password for Level 3

7ZZZ2LFrykP2zEyvBL4m3c1cL7tGYJPME

Then exit the level.

```
bandit2@bandit:~$ cat "--spaces in this filename--"  
7ZZZ2LFrykP2zEyvBL4m3c1cL7tGYJPME  
bandit2@bandit:~$ |
```